

Hackathon Synergy Report

Our group divided up the work so that each member was able to contribute to developing and refining the visuals for each Chart. A theme was decided and the charts/work was divided out before beginning the hackathon.

Susan worked on the development and base structure for Chart 1, which was the variable-width column. Yuddh worked on the base structure for Charts 2, 3, and 4 which were the embedded table, bar, and the column charts. After all charts were functional, Rose focused on refining their presentation and overall consistency with the team's design.

Chart 1 changes were as followed:

- Changed the title from “Regional Happy Planet Index vs. Population Size (2025)” to “Larger Populations Do Not Necessarily Mean Higher HPI Scores in 2025”.

Chart 2 changes were as followed:

- Turned the Life Satisfaction values into embedded horizontal bars.

Chart 3 changes were as followed:

- Changed the title from “HPI Scores of the Top and Bottom 20 Countries in 2025” to “Latin America & Caribbean Accounts for Half of the 2025 HPI Top 20”
- Added the subtitle “The dotted line separates the 20 highest - and lowest scoring countries”.

Chart 4 changes were as followed:

- Changed the original descriptive title “Average Ecological Footprint by Region in 2025” to the more explanatory “The West Has the Largest Average Ecological Footprints in 2025”

Finally, we all used GitHub Desktop to review code changes, commit our contributions to the shared repository, and push them to GitHub. This allowed for all of our individual contributions to be documented in the team's commit history while integrating changes with the work completed by the other group members. R-Studio was utilized to complete the project as well.

If we were to complete the hackathon again, we would explore different variables within the dataset and see if there were any uncovered patterns or visuals that could be expanded on. We would also look at different years and experiment with the size, position, and layout of the graphs. Comparing sizing and positioning is important for data visualization.